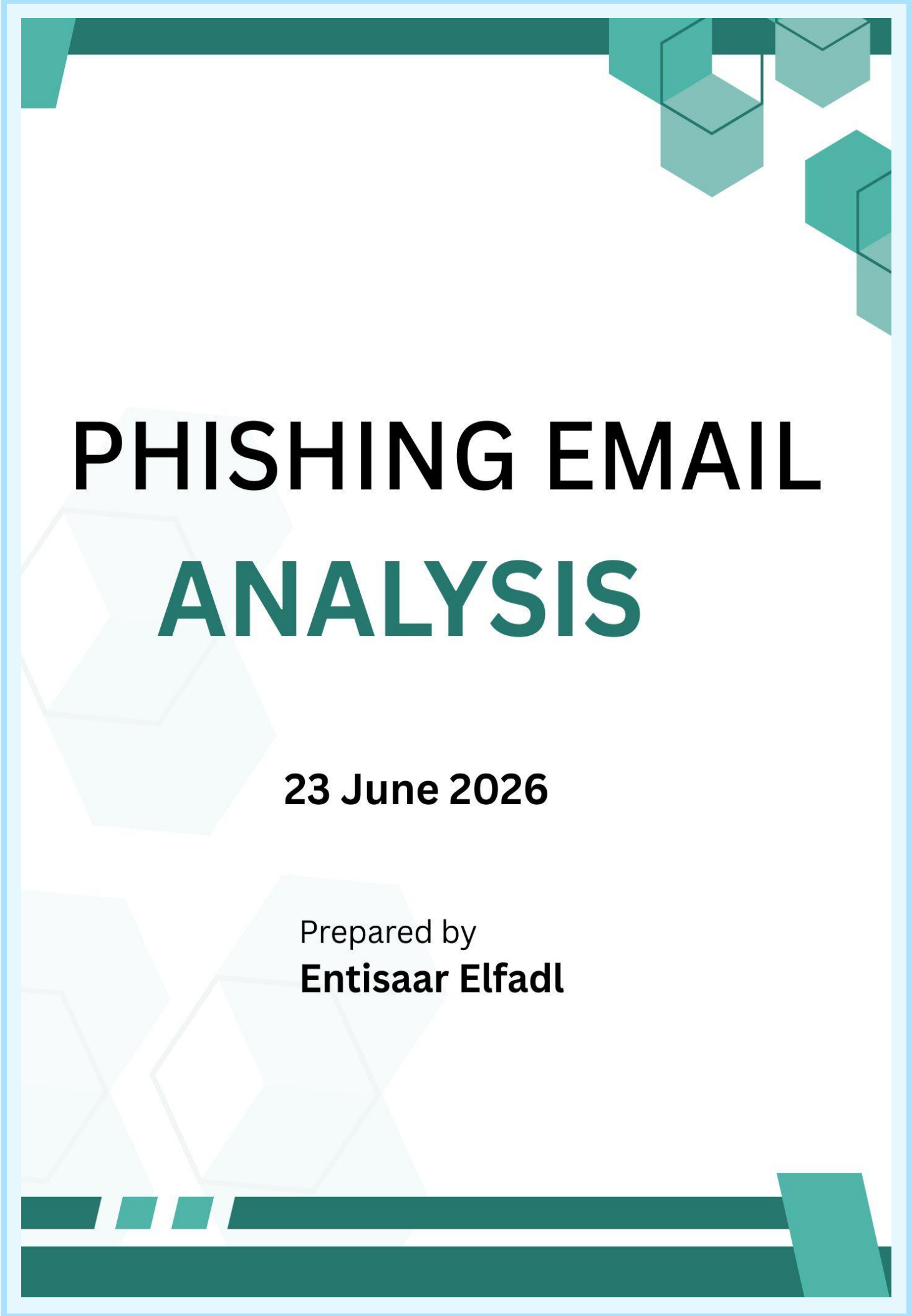




PHISHING EMAIL ANALYSIS

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Introduction

Phishing is one of the most common cyber attacks used to steal sensitive information such as usernames, passwords, and banking details. The objective of this task was to investigate real phishing email samples obtained from a public research dataset by analysing their headers, identifying phishing indicators, examining embedded links, and documenting the findings.

The investigation was carried out using Linux command line tools together with online threat intelligence platforms including VirusTotal and urlscan.io.

Objectives

The objectives of this investigation were to:

- ♥ Analyse raw phishing email samples.
- ♥ Extract and interpret important email headers.
- ♥ Identify social engineering techniques.
- ♥ Safely analyse embedded hyperlinks.
- ♥ Compare multiple phishing campaigns.
- ♥ Recommend security controls to reduce phishing risk.

Tools Used

Tool	Purpose
Linux Terminal	Header extraction using cat and grep
VS Code	Viewing raw .eml files, and Updating Github
VirusTotal	URL reputation analysis
urlscan.io	Website behaviour analysis
BlackheathPoint	Defanging URL
Microsoft Word	Report Creation

Methodology

The following process was followed for each phishing email:

1. Created the .eml file from the phishing email example extracted from the .mbox file.
2. Extracted important email headers using Linux commands.
3. Identified sender information, Reply-To address, recipient list and spam headers.
4. Examined the email body for phishing indicators.
5. Defanged all embedded URLs before documenting them.
6. Submitted the URLs to VirusTotal and urlscan.io without visiting the websites directly.
7. Classified each email based on the evidence collected.

Phishing Email Analysis

Sample 1 Analysis

Header Analysis using Linux

```
</html>From: "Credit Union" <acc-validity@ncua.gov>  
Reply-To: "Credit Union" <service@cuna.org>  
Subject: [*** POSSIBLE SPAM***] FCU: Account update  
Reply-To: "Credit Union" <service@cuna.org>  
To: foobee@example.com, jmore@example.com, cin2000@example.com  
X-Spam-Flag: YES
```

Findings:

- ♥ Three separate recipients were targeted simultaneously.
- ♥ SpamAssassin flagged the email as spam with a score of 16.8, well above the threshold of 5.0.

Analysis

Although the sender appears to represent the National Credit Union Administration, replies would be sent to a different domain (cuna.org). This mismatch is unusual and should be treated as suspicious.

The email was also sent to multiple recipients, indicating that it was likely part of a mass phishing campaign rather than a personalised communication.

The high SpamAssassin score suggests that the email gateway identified several characteristics commonly associated with phishing emails.

Social Engineering Analysis

The email attempts to create urgency by informing the recipient that their account access has been limited until additional information is provided.

It encourages the victim to click a verification link by suggesting that account functionality will remain restricted until action is taken.

The inclusion of a case identification number makes the message appear more legitimate and attempts to increase the recipient's trust.

URL Analysis

The displayed link shows "My Online Banking".

The actual destination is <http://200.73.81.212/.CREDIT-UNION/update.php>, and the **defanged link created is** "hxxp://200[.]73[.]81[.]212/.CREDIT-UNION/update.php"

Observations

The destination uses a raw IP address rather than an official banking domain.

Legitimate financial institutions normally use HTTPS together with their registered domain names rather than numerical IP addresses.

This is a common phishing indicator.

VirusTotal Analysis

The URL was submitted to VirusTotal.

At the time of analysis:

- ♥ No participating security vendors classified the URL as malicious.
- ♥ Several vendors returned an "Unrated" status.
- ♥ VirusTotal could not successfully scan the website because the server did not respond.

Although VirusTotal did not detect the URL as malicious, the surrounding evidence strongly indicates that the email is a phishing attempt.

This demonstrates an important cybersecurity principle stating that threat intelligence tools should support an investigation, not replace human judgement.

Classification: Phishing

We know this because of:

- ♥ Brand impersonation.
- ♥ Urgency designed to pressure the recipient.
- ♥ Suspicious Reply-To address.
- ♥ Multiple recipients.
- ♥ Raw IP address used instead of a trusted banking website.
- ♥ SpamAssassin score significantly above the spam threshold.

Lessons Learnt

This sample demonstrated that phishing detection should never rely on a single indicator.

Although VirusTotal did not identify the URL as malicious, analysing the email headers, message content, sender information and embedded link clearly revealed multiple phishing indicators.

Combining technical analysis with human judgement provides a much more reliable assessment than relying solely on automated security tools.

Sample 2 Analysis

Header Analysis using Linux

```
</html>From: "PayPal" <service@paypal.com>  
Subject: Verify Your PayPal® Account  
To: username@example.com  
X-Spam-Flag: YES  
X-Spam-Status: Yes, score=14.2 required=5.0
```

Findings:

- ♥ The recipient is username@example.com.
- ♥ SpamAssassin flagged the email as spam with a score of 14.2, exceeding the threshold of 5.0.

Analysis

The email claims to originate from PayPal by displaying the address service@paypal.com, which is intended to build trust with the recipient. Unlike the first sample, there is no separate Reply-To address, meaning there is no obvious mismatch between the sender and reply address.

Despite appearing to come from a trusted company, the email was flagged as spam by SpamAssassin with a score of 14.2, indicating that several characteristics matched known phishing patterns.

The message was addressed to a single recipient, making it appear more personal than a mass-distributed phishing email.

Social Engineering Analysis

The attacker attempts to create fear by claiming that the recipient's PayPal account has been temporarily restricted because of unauthorised login attempts from an unknown IP address.

The email states that the account must be verified immediately and warns that failure to do so within 48 hours will result in permanent suspension.

This combination of urgency and fear is a common social engineering technique designed to pressure the victim into acting quickly without carefully examining the email.

URL Analysis

The displayed link is "https://www.paypal.com/cgi-bin/webscr?cmd=_login-run".

The actual destination link is <http://200.73.81.212/.CREDIT-UNION/update.php>, and the **defanged link created is** "hxxp://www[.]paypal[.]com[.]member-profile9652[.]info/index.php"

Observations

One of the strongest phishing indicators in this email is that the visible link does not match the actual destination.

The text displayed to the user appears to be a legitimate PayPal login page. However, clicking the link would redirect the user to a completely different domain.

The attackers have included paypal.com as part of a much longer domain name to make it appear legitimate at first glance. The real registered domain is member-profile9652.info, which has no association with PayPal.

This technique is commonly known as URL spoofing or deceptive hyperlink masking.

VirusTotal Analysis

The URL was submitted to VirusTotal.

At the time of analysis:

- ♥ No participating security vendors identified the URL as malicious.
- ♥ Many security vendors returned an Unrated result.
- ♥ The URL was not listed on major phishing blocklists.

Although VirusTotal did not classify the website as malicious, the email itself contains several strong phishing indicators.

The mismatch between the displayed hyperlink and the actual destination, together with the urgent language and account verification request, provides sufficient evidence to classify this email as a phishing attempt.

This reinforces the importance of combining automated threat intelligence with manual investigation.

Classification: Phishing

Evidence:

- ♥ Impersonates PayPal to gain the recipient's trust.
- ♥ Creates urgency by threatening permanent account suspension.
- ♥ Requests immediate identity verification.
- ♥ Uses a deceptive hyperlink that disguises the true destination.
- ♥ SpamAssassin score of 14.2, significantly above the spam threshold.
- ♥ Uses a suspicious ".info" domain that is unrelated to PayPal.

Lessons Learnt

This sample demonstrates how attackers can manipulate hyperlinks to deceive users. While the visible text appears to direct the user to the official PayPal website, the underlying URL points to an unrelated domain designed to steal login credentials.

The investigation also showed that automated security tools may not always classify phishing URLs as malicious. For this reason, users should always inspect hyperlinks carefully before clicking them and verify that the destination domain belongs to the organisation it claims to represent.

Manual analysis of email content, sender information, and embedded links remains an essential part of phishing detection.

Sample 3 Analysis

Header Analysis using Linux

```
<pre>regards,for eBay -Satchel for -Team,pp>
</body>
</html>From: "eBay Member Services" <aw-confirm@ebay.com>
Reply-To: <aw-confirm@ebay.com>
Subject: New email address added to your eBay account !
Reply-To: <aw-confirm@ebay.com>
To: user@example.com
X-Spam-Flag: YES
X-Spam-Status: Yes, score=11.5 required=5.0
```

Findings:

- ♥ The recipient is user@example.com
- ♥ SpamAssassin flagged the email as spam with a score of 14.2, exceeding the threshold of 5.0.

Analysis

The email appears to originate from an official eBay address and the Reply-To address matches the sender, making it appear more trustworthy than the previous samples.

The message was sent to a single recipient, increasing the appearance of legitimacy.

Despite these seemingly authentic details, SpamAssassin assigned the email a score of **11.5**, indicating that the message contained several characteristics commonly associated with phishing emails.

This demonstrates that attackers often combine legitimate-looking sender information with convincing content in an attempt to deceive recipients.

Social Engineering Analysis

Unlike the previous samples, which encouraged users to verify their accounts, this phishing email attempts to create panic by informing the recipient that their eBay account email address has already been changed.

The email states that a new address, **newuser77@mail-backup.net**, has been added to the account and instructs the user to cancel the request immediately if they did not authorise the change.

This technique creates fear that the victim's account has already been compromised, increasing the likelihood that they will click the provided link without verifying its authenticity.

The attacker relies on urgency and fear of account takeover to manipulate the recipient into revealing their credentials.

URL Analysis

The displayed destination is "Click here to cancel the change request".

The actual destination link is `http://signin-ebay-co-uk.3web.ne.jp/ws2/eBayISAPI.dll.html`, and the **defanged link created is** "`hxxp://signin-ebay-co-uk[.]3web[.]ne[.]jp/ws2/eBayISAPI.dll.html`".

Observations

The hyperlink does not direct users to an official eBay website.

Instead, the destination is hosted under the **3web.ne.jp** domain, which has no connection to eBay.

The attackers attempt to deceive users by embedding words such as **signin**, **ebay**, and **co-uk** within the subdomain, hoping recipients will only notice familiar terms without checking the actual registered domain.

The legitimate registered domain is **3web.ne.jp**, making this a clear example of domain impersonation.

VirusTotal Analysis

The URL was submitted to VirusTotal for analysis.

At the time of analysis:

- ♥ No participating security vendors identified the URL as malicious.
- ♥ Several vendors returned an Unrated status.
- ♥ The URL was not listed by major phishing databases.

Although the URL was not detected as malicious by VirusTotal, the investigation identified multiple phishing indicators.

The suspicious destination domain, combined with the urgency of the message and the attempt to imitate eBay, provides sufficient evidence to classify the email as phishing.

This demonstrates that automated security tools should be used alongside manual analysis rather than relied upon as the sole method of identifying phishing attacks.

Classification: Phishing

Evidence:

- ♥ Creates urgency by claiming an unauthorised email address has been added to the user's account.
- ♥ Encourages immediate action to prevent account compromise.
- ♥ Uses a deceptive hyperlink hosted on an unrelated domain.
- ♥ SpamAssassin score of 11.5, significantly above the spam threshold.
- ♥ Attempts to disguise the destination by including "ebay" within the subdomain rather than using an official eBay domain.

Lessons Learnt

This sample highlights how attackers often use convincing account security notifications to manipulate users into acting quickly.

Unlike the previous samples, which requested account verification, this email claimed that an account change had already occurred. This tactic increases anxiety and encourages immediate action.

The investigation also demonstrated that a website may not be flagged by automated security scanners even when multiple phishing indicators are present. Careful inspection of the sender information, message content and destination URL remains essential when determining whether an email is legitimate.

Comparative Analysis

After analysing the three phishing email samples, several common patterns emerged. Although each email impersonated a different organisation and used a different social engineering approach, they all shared the same objective of persuading recipients to reveal sensitive information by clicking a malicious link.

Feature	Sample 1 (Credit Union)	Sample 2 (PayPal)	Sample 3 (eBay)
Brand impersonated	National Credit Union Administration	PayPal	eBay
Primary emotion used	Fear of account restrictions	Fear of account suspension	Panic over account takeover
Requests immediate action	Yes	Yes	Yes
Uses urgency	Yes	Yes	Yes
Embedded hyperlink	Yes	Yes	Yes
Destination uses official domain	No	No	No
SpamAssassin flagged	Yes (16.8)	Yes (14.2)	Yes (11.5)
VirusTotal detection	No detections	No detections	No detections
Final classification	Phishing	Phishing	Phishing

Key Findings

There were several important observations were made during the investigation:

- ♥ Trusted brands are frequently impersonated.
Each phishing email impersonated a well-known organisation with which users are likely to have an account. This increases the likelihood that recipients will trust the message and follow its instructions.
- ♥ Urgency was present in every sample.
All three emails attempted to pressure recipients into acting quickly by threatening restricted accounts, permanent suspension, or unauthorised account changes. Creating urgency reduces the likelihood that users will carefully inspect suspicious emails.
- ♥ The hyperlinks were deceptive.
Each sample attempted to hide the true destination of its hyperlink.
 - Sample 1 directed users to a raw IP address.
 - Sample 2 displayed a legitimate-looking PayPal URL while redirecting users to an unrelated ".info" domain.
 - Sample 3 used an unrelated Japanese domain while embedding "ebay" within the subdomain to appear legitimate.
- ♥ Automated tools alone were insufficient.
Although all three emails contained clear phishing indicators, none of the URLs were detected as malicious by VirusTotal during the investigation. This demonstrates that security tools should complement, rather than replace, manual analysis.

Recommendations

Based on the findings of this investigation, the following recommendations are proposed to reduce the risk of phishing attacks.

Technical Recommendations

- ♥ Configure email gateways to quarantine messages with high SpamAssassin scores before they reach users.
- ♥ Enforce SPF, DKIM and DMARC policies to improve email authentication and reduce domain spoofing.
- ♥ Block emails containing hyperlinks that use raw IP addresses or suspicious domains where appropriate.
- ♥ Continue using threat intelligence platforms such as VirusTotal and urlscan.io to investigate suspicious URLs before visiting them.
- ♥ Monitor organisational email logs for repeated phishing attempts targeting employees.

User Awareness Recommendations

- ♥ Always verify the sender's email address rather than relying solely on the displayed name.
- ♥ Hover over hyperlinks before clicking to inspect the actual destination.
- ♥ Be cautious of messages that create urgency or threaten account suspension.
- ♥ Never provide passwords or sensitive personal information through links received in unsolicited emails.
- ♥ Report suspicious emails to the organisation's IT or cybersecurity team instead of interacting with them.

This investigation demonstrated that phishing detection requires both technical analysis and critical thinking. Header information, sender identity, message content, embedded links and contextual clues must all be considered together when determining whether an email is legitimate.

Conclusion

This investigation analysed three phishing email samples obtained from a public research dataset. Each sample used different social engineering techniques and different methods of disguising malicious hyperlinks; however, all shared the objective of convincing recipients to disclose sensitive information or interact with fraudulent websites.

The investigation involved analysing raw email headers using Linux command line tools, identifying phishing indicators within the message content, defanging embedded URLs, and investigating those URLs using VirusTotal and urlscan.io. Although none of the analysed URLs were detected as malicious by VirusTotal at the time of investigation, manual analysis revealed multiple indicators that clearly identified each email as a phishing attempt.

The investigation reinforced several important cybersecurity principles. Legitimate-looking sender information does not guarantee that an email is trustworthy. Automated security tools should support, rather than replace, human analysis. Finally, user awareness remains one of the most effective defences against phishing attacks.

Overall, this task strengthened my understanding of email header analysis, social engineering techniques, phishing detection, safe handling of suspicious URLs, and the importance of combining technical investigation with critical analysis when assessing potential cyber threats.

Appendix

Linux Command Output

```
entisaar@Enti:/mnt/c/Users/entis/OneDrive - University of Cape Town/Personal/Task 2/FUTURE_CS_02/sample email evidence$ cat sample1.eml

grep "From:" sample1.eml
grep "Reply-To:" sample1.eml
grep "Subject:" sample1.eml
grep "To:" sample1.eml
grep "X-Spam" sample1.eml
From: "Credit Union" <acc-validity@cua.gov>
Reply-To: "Credit Union" <service@cua.org>
To: foobee@example.com, jmore@example.com, cin2000@example.com
Subject: [*** POSSIBLE SPAM***] FCU: Account update
Date: Tue, 15 Nov 2005 18:34:57 -0500
MIME-Version: 1.0
Content-Type: text/html; charset="UTF-8"
Content-Transfer-Encoding: 7bit
X-Spam-Flag: YES
X-Spam-Status: Yes, score=16.8 required=5.0

<html>
<body>
<p>Dear Credit Union Member,</p>
<p>We recently reviewed your account, and we need more information to help us provide you with secure service. Until we can collect this information, your access to sensitive account features will be limited.</p>
<p>We apologize for any inconvenience this may cause. Please click the link below to verify your profile details.</p>
<p>Case ID: PCU1-131-817-721726</p>
<p><a href="http://200.73.81.212/.CREDIT-UNION/update.php">My Online Banking</a></p>
<p>Thank you,<br>National Credit Union Administration</p>
</body>
</html>From: "Credit Union" <acc-validity@cua.gov>
Reply-To: "Credit Union" <service@cua.org>
Subject: [*** POSSIBLE SPAM***] FCU: Account update
Reply-To: "Credit Union" <service@cua.org>
To: foobee@example.com, jmore@example.com, cin2000@example.com
X-Spam-Flag: YES
```

Appendix A: Sample 1 Linux Output

```
entisaar@Enti:/mnt/c/Users/entis/OneDrive - University of Cape Town/Personal/Task 2/FUTURE_CS_02/sample email evidence$ cat sample2.eml

grep "From:" sample2.eml
grep "Reply-To:" sample2.eml
grep "Subject:" sample2.eml
grep "To:" sample2.eml
grep "X-Spam" sample2.eml
From: "PayPal" <service@paypal.com>
To: username@example.com
Subject: Verify Your PayPal Account
Date: Wed, 16 Nov 2005 04:12:21 -0500
MIME-Version: 1.0
Content-Type: text/html; charset="UTF-8"
Content-Transfer-Encoding: 7bit
X-Spam-Flag: YES
X-Spam-Status: Yes, score=14.2 required=5.0

<html>
<body>
<p>Dear PayPal Member,</p>
<p>Your PayPal account has been temporarily restricted due to unauthorized login attempts from an unrecognized IP address. To restore full functionality to your account, you are required to confirm your identity immediately.</p>
<p>Failure to verify your account within 48 hours will lead to permanent suspension.</p>
<p><a href="http://www.paypal.com/member-profile9652.info/index.php">https://www.paypal.com/cgi-bin/webscr?cmd=_login-run</a></p>
<p>Sincerely,<br>PayPal Security Department</p>
</body>
</html>From: "PayPal" <service@paypal.com>
Subject: Verify Your PayPal Account
To: username@example.com
X-Spam-Flag: YES
X-Spam-Status: Yes, score=14.2 required=5.0
```

Appendix B: Sample 2 Linux Output

```
entisaar@Enti:/mnt/c/Users/entis/OneDrive - University of Cape Town/Personal/Task 2/FUTURE_CS_02/sample email evidence$ cat sample3.eml

grep "From:" sample3.eml
grep "Reply-To:" sample3.eml
grep "Subject:" sample3.eml
grep "To:" sample3.eml
grep "X-Spam" sample3.eml
From: "eBay Member Services" <aw-confirm@ebay.com>
Reply-To: <aw-confirm@ebay.com>
To: user@example.com
Subject: New email address added to your eBay account !
Date: Thu, 17 Nov 2005 11:22:04 -0500
MIME-Version: 1.0
Content-Type: text/html; charset="UTF-8"
Content-Transfer-Encoding: 7bit
X-Spam-Flag: YES
X-Spam-Status: Yes, score=11.5 required=5.0

<html>
<body>
<p>Dear eBay Member,</p>
<p>This is an automated notification confirming that the email address associated with your eBay profile has been successfully updated to <strong>newuser77@mail-backup.net</strong>.</p>
<p>If you did not authorize this change and suspect a malicious party has accessed your account, you must cancel the request immediately using the secure portal below:</p>
<p><a href="http://signin-ebay-co-uk.3web.ne.jp/ws2/eBayISAPI.dll.html">Click here to cancel the change request</a></p>
<p>Regards,<br>eBay Safe Harbor Team</p>
</body>
</html>From: "eBay Member Services" <aw-confirm@ebay.com>
Reply-To: <aw-confirm@ebay.com>
Subject: New email address added to your eBay account !
Reply-To: <aw-confirm@ebay.com>
To: user@example.com
```

Appendix C: Sample 3 Linux Output

VirusTotal Results

0
/ 97

Community Score

✓ No security vendors flagged this URL as malicious

Reanalyze Search More

http://200.73.81.212/.CREDIT-UNION/update.php

200.73.81.212

Last Analysis Date

1 year ago

ip

DETECTION

DETAILS

COMMUNITY

Join our Community and enjoy additional community insights and crowdsourced detections, plus an API key to automate checks.

Security vendors' analysis

Do you want to automate checks?

Abusix	✓ Clean
Acronis	✓ Clean
ADMINUSLabs	✓ Clean
AILabs (MONITORAPP)	✓ Clean
AlienVault	✓ Clean
Antiy-AVL	✓ Clean
Artists Against 419	✓ Clean
benkow.cc	✓ Clean
BitDefender	✓ Clean

Appendix D: Sample 1 VirusTotal Scan

0
/ 50

Community Score

✓ No security vendors flagged this URL as malicious

Reanalyze Search More

http://www.paypal.com/member-profile/9652.info/index.php

www.paypal.com/member-profile/9652.info

Last Analysis Date

a moment ago

DETECTION

DETAILS

COMMUNITY

Join our Community and enjoy additional community insights and crowdsourced detections, plus an API key to automate checks.

Security vendors' analysis

Do you want to automate checks?

Abusix	✓ Clean	Acronis	✓ Clean
ADMINUSLabs	✓ Clean	AILabs (MONITORAPP)	✓ Clean
AlienVault	✓ Clean	Antiy-AVL	✓ Clean
BitDefender	✓ Clean	BlockList	✓ Clean
Blusiv	✓ Clean	Certego	✓ Clean
Chong Lua Dao	✓ Clean	CINIS Army	✓ Clean
CRDF	✓ Clean	Criminal IP	✓ Clean
CTX.AI	✓ Clean	Cyble	✓ Clean
CyRadar	✓ Clean	desenmascara.me	✓ Clean
Dr.Web	✓ Clean	EmergingThreats	✓ Clean
Emissoft	✓ Clean	ESET	✓ Clean
ESTsecurity	✓ Clean	Fortinet	✓ Clean
G Data	✓ Clean	Google Safebrowsing	✓ Clean

Appendix E: Sample 2 VirusTotal Scan

0
/ 102

Community Score

http://login-elbay.co.uk/auth.me_getVCS.php?API_ID.html

login-elbay.co.uk/auth.me_getVCS.php

Last Analysis Date

a moment ago

DETECTION

DETAILS

COMMUNITY

Join our Community and enjoy additional community insights and crowdsourced detections, plus an API key to automate checks.

Security vendors' analysis

Do you want to automate checks?

Abusix	✓ Clean	Acronis	✓ Clean
ADMINUSLabs	✓ Clean	AILabs (MONITORAPP)	✓ Clean
AlienVault	✓ Clean	Antiy-AVL	✓ Clean
BitDefender	✓ Clean	BlockList	✓ Clean
Blusiv	✓ Clean	Certego	✓ Clean
CINIS Army	✓ Clean	CRDF	✓ Clean
Criminal IP	✓ Clean	CTX.AI	✓ Clean
Cyble	✓ Clean	CyRadar	✓ Clean
desenmascara.me	✓ Clean	Dr.Web	✓ Clean
EmergingThreats	✓ Clean	Emissoft	✓ Clean
ESET	✓ Clean	ESTsecurity	✓ Clean
Fortinet	✓ Clean	Google Safebrowsing	✓ Clean
Freepoint ThreatSeeker	✓ Clean	Himal Security	✓ Clean
G Data	✓ Clean	Juniper Networks	✓ Clean
GreenSnow	✓ Clean	LevelBlue	✓ Clean
IPsum	✓ Clean	Mahamoud	✓ Clean
Kaspersky	✓ Clean	OpenFish	✓ Clean
Linux	✓ Clean		
MalwarePatrol	✓ Clean		

Appendix F: Sample 3 VirusTotal Scan

Defanged URLs

BlackheathPoint



destination for proper analysis and threat assessment.

`http://200.73.81.212/.CREDIT-UNION/update.php`

Defang URL

The defanged URL is:

`hxxp[:]200[.]73[.]81[.]212/.CREDIT-UNION/update.php`

Appendix I: Sample 1 Defanged

BlackheathPoint



suspicious links with security teams. It modifies URLs to prevent accidental clicks while allowing intended recipients to examine them. This process bypasses spam filters and quarantine measures, ensuring the links reach their destination for proper analysis and threat assessment.

`http://www.paypal.com.member-profile9652.info/i`

Defang URL

The defanged URL is:

`hxxp[:]www[.]paypal[.]com[.]member-profile9652[.]info/index.php`

Appendix H: Sample 2 VirusTotal Scan

BlackheathPoint

measures, ensuring the links reach their destination for proper analysis and threat assessment.

`http://signin-ebay-co-uk.3web.ne.jp/ws2/eBayISAPI.dll.ht`

Defang URL

The defanged URL is:

`hxxp[:]signin-ebay-co-uk[.]3web[.]ne[.]jp/ws2/eBayISAPI.dll.html`

Appendix G: Sample 3 VirusTotal Scan